

7-Day Healthy Vegetarian South Indian Meal Plan

Weekly Meal Plan | learn. build. operate

1. Plan Overview

This is a **healthy, balanced 7-day vegetarian South Indian meal plan**, prepared to support steady, sustainable weight loss. Every day brings together breakfast, lunch, a snack and dinner, built from real, everyday dishes: idli with sambar, kootu and poriyal, rasam, millet dosas and more. Each meal pairs whole grains or millets with dals, vegetables and curd, in comfortable, ordinary portions, using ingredients found in any local market.

Plan profile

WHO IT IS FOR

Adult working towards gradual weight loss

ALLERGIES & DISLIKES

None noted

DIET STYLE

Vegetarian · South Indian

ACTIVITY LEVEL

Light to moderate

WEEKDAY COOKING TIME

About 30–45 minutes

MEALS EACH DAY

Breakfast · lunch · snack · dinner

2. The Week at a Glance

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	SNACK	DINNER
MON	Idli & sambar	Rice, pumpkin kootu & beans poriyal	Chickpea sundal	Pesarattu with ginger chutney
TUE	Vegetable rava upma	Rice, keera kootu, okra poriyal & rasam	Guava & spiced buttermilk	Ragi dosa with sambar
WED	Ven pongal & sambar	Sambar rice, beetroot poriyal & raita	Peanut sundal	Adai with avial
THU	Idiyappam & vegetable kurma	Rice, drumstick sambar & cabbage thoran	Sprouted moong salad	Phulka with sorakkai kootu
FRI	Vegetable uttapam	Rice, ash gourd mor kuzhambu & carrot-peas poriyal	Papaya & pomegranate bowl	Kuzhi paniyaram & mint chutney
SAT	Ragi puttu & kadala curry	Bisi bele bath & cucumber raita	Vegetable kozhukattai	Appam with vegetable stew
SUN	Masala dosa & sambar	Rice, sambar, kovakkai poriyal, rasam & curd	Ragi malt	Thinai khichdi & cucumber raita

3. Day-by-Day Meal Plan

Four wholesome meals a day, with every dish and portion laid out for easy cooking and shopping.

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
MON DAY 1	BREAKFAST	Idli with sambar Steamed idli, lentil-vegetable sambar and coconut-mint chutney	3 idli · 1 katori sambar · 1 tbsp chutney
	LUNCH	Rice, pumpkin kootu, beans poriyal Pumpkin and moong dal kootu, beans stir-fried with coconut, plain curd	$\frac{3}{4}$ cup rice · 1 katori kootu · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup poriyal · 1 katori curd
	SNACK	Chickpea sundal Boiled chickpeas with mustard, curry leaves and fresh coconut	$\frac{1}{2}$ cup
	DINNER	Pesarattu with ginger chutney Green moong dosa, rich in protein and fibre	2 medium dosa · 1 tbsp chutney
DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
TUE DAY 2	BREAKFAST	Vegetable rava upma Semolina with carrot, beans and peas, tempered with curry leaves	1 cup upma · 1 tbsp coconut chutney
	LUNCH	Rice, keera kootu, okra poriyal, tomato rasam Spinach and moong dal kootu, lightly sautéed okra, tangy tomato rasam	$\frac{3}{4}$ cup rice · 1 katori kootu · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup poriyal · 1 cup rasam
	SNACK	Guava with spiced buttermilk Fresh guava slices and neer mor with ginger, curry leaves and coriander	1 small guava · 1 glass (200 ml) buttermilk
	DINNER	Ragi dosa with sambar Finger-millet dosa, a calcium-rich favourite, with tomato-onion chutney	2 medium dosa · 1 katori sambar · 1 tbsp chutney
DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
WED DAY 3	BREAKFAST	Ven pongal with sambar Rice and moong dal pongal with pepper, cumin and a touch of ghee	1 cup pongal · $\frac{1}{2}$ katori sambar
	LUNCH	Sambar rice, beetroot poriyal, cucumber raita One-pot rice, toor dal and vegetables, with a bright beetroot stir-fry	1 cup sambar rice · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup poriyal · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup raita
	SNACK	Peanut sundal Boiled peanuts with grated coconut and green chilli	$\frac{1}{2}$ cup
	DINNER	Adai with avial Mixed-lentil dosa with a coconut-and-curd vegetable avial	2 medium adai · $\frac{3}{4}$ cup avial

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
THU DAY 4	BREAKFAST	Idiyappam with vegetable kurma Steamed rice-noodle string hoppers with a light coconut vegetable kurma	3 idiyappam · ½ katori kurma
	LUNCH	Rice, drumstick sambar, cabbage thoran Drumstick and toor dal sambar, cabbage tossed with fresh coconut	¾ cup rice · 1 katori sambar · ½ cup thoran
	SNACK	Sprouted moong salad Sprouted green gram with onion, tomato, coriander and lime	1 cup
	DINNER	Phulka with sorakkai kootu Whole-wheat phulka with bottle gourd and chana dal kootu	2 phulka · 1 katori kootu

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
FRI DAY 5	BREAKFAST	Vegetable uttapam Soft dosa topped with onion, tomato, carrot and coriander, with coconut chutney	2 small uttapam · 1 tbsp chutney
	LUNCH	Rice, ash gourd mor kuzhambu, carrot-peas poriyal Buttermilk-coconut curry with ash gourd, lightly spiced carrot and peas	¾ cup rice · 1 katori kuzhambu · ½ cup poriyal
	SNACK	Papaya and pomegranate bowl Fresh seasonal fruit with a squeeze of lime	1 cup
	DINNER	Vegetable kuzhi paniyaram Lentil-rice bites with grated vegetables and mint-coriander chutney	5 paniyaram · 1 tbsp chutney

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
SAT DAY 6	BREAKFAST	Ragi puttlu with kadala curry Steamed finger-millet and coconut puttlu with black chickpea curry	1 cup puttlu · ½ katori kadala curry
	LUNCH	Bisi bele bath with cucumber raita Karnataka-style one-pot of rice, lentils and vegetables	1 cup bisi bele bath · ½ cup raita
	SNACK	Vegetable kozhukattai Steamed rice-flour dumplings with a vegetable-coconut filling	3 pieces
	DINNER	Appam with vegetable stew Soft fermented rice hoppers with a light coconut-milk vegetable stew	2 appam · 1 katori stew

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
SUN DAY 7	BREAKFAST	Vegetable masala dosa with sambar Crisp dosa, a light vegetable filling and sambar	1 large dosa · 1 katori sambar
	LUNCH	Rice, sambar, kovakkai poriyal, rasam, curd A classic Sunday thali-style lunch	$\frac{3}{4}$ cup rice · 1 katori sambar · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup poriyal · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup rasam · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup curd
	SNACK	Ragi malt Warm finger-millet porridge, lightly sweetened with jaggery	1 glass (200 ml)
	DINNER	Thinai vegetable khichdi with cucumber raita Foxtail millet and moong dal cooked with vegetables, with cooling raita	1 cup khichdi · $\frac{1}{2}$ cup raita

4. Portion Guide

1 katori is a small serving bowl of about 150 ml. **1 cup** is a standard 240 ml measuring cup. A **medium dosa** is roughly 20 cm across, and a **glass** is 200 ml. Using the same bowls each day keeps portions steady and easy to repeat.

5. Market Basket for the Week

GRAINS & MILLETS

Idli rice and raw rice, rava (semolina), ragi flour, foxtail millet (thinai), whole-wheat flour, rice flour (for idiyappam and kozhukattai)

DALS & LEGUMES

Toor dal, moong dal (split and whole), chana dal, urad dal, chickpeas, black chickpeas (kadala), green gram for sprouting, peanuts

VEGETABLES & GREENS

Pumpkin, beans, okra, drumstick, cabbage, ash gourd, bottle gourd (sorakkai), beetroot, carrot, peas, kovakkai (ivy gourd), spinach (keerai), cucumber, tomato, onion

FRUIT, DAIRY & PANTRY

Guava, papaya, pomegranate, curd and buttermilk, fresh coconut, ginger, green chilli, curry leaves, coriander, mint, jaggery, ghee, mustard, cumin, pepper, tamarind, sambar and rasam powders

This is a sample plan for inspiration. A qualified dietitian can tailor it to individual needs and preferences.